TRADEGENIUS

# System Architecture

v5.1.2

April 2026

Repo: valira3/stock-spike-monitor
Service: tradegenius.up.railway.app

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# TradeGenius — System Architecture

> **Version:** v5.1.2 · April 2026 **Repo:** `valira3/stock-spike-monitor` · **Service:** `tradegenius.up.railway.app` **Source of truth:** `STRATEGY.md` (canonical trading-logic spec), `trade_genius.py`, `tiger_buffalo_v5.py`, `volume_profile.py`, `indicators.py`, `bar_archive.py`, `dashboard_server.py`, `dashboard_static/{app.js,app.css,index.html}`

TradeGenius is a Python Telegram-driven trading bot with a paper book, two Alpaca-backed executor mirrors, and a live web dashboard. As of **v5.0.0** it runs the **Tiger/Buffalo two-stage state machine** for both long ("The Tiger Hunts the Bison") and short ("The Wounded Buffalo / Gravity Trade") trades on a small, hand-curated ticker universe; emits ENTRY/EXIT signals on an in-process bus; and (when configured) replicates those signals against Alpaca paper or live via two independent executor bots. **v5.1.0–v5.1.2** layered an observation-only **Forensic Volume Filter** ( `volume_profile.py` ) plus **Forensic Capture** modules ( `bar_archive.py` , `indicators.py` ) on top of the v5.0.0 algorithm — all of v5.1.x is shadow-mode only and does not change a single Tiger/Buffalo entry decision.

The canonical specification of the trading logic lives in `STRATEGY.md` at the repo root. Sections 6 and 7 below summarize the v5 algorithm and risk model; for any disagreement between this file and `STRATEGY.md` , **`STRATEGY.md` is authoritative**.

App was branded **Stock Spike Monitor** through v3.5.0; renamed to **TradeGenius** in v3.5.1. The pre-v3.5.0 TradersPost mirror portfolio, Robinhood surface, and Gmail/IMAP intake have all been removed and are not part of the current system.

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## 1. High-level overview

```
                    ┌──────────────────────────────────────┐
                    │   Railway container (single process)   │
                    │                                        │
   Telegram ──────►│  trade_genius.py                       │
   (main bot,       │   ├─ Scheduler thread                  │
    Val bot,        │   │   • scan_loop() every 60s          │
    Gene bot)       │   │   • timed jobs (09:30/35/55, ...)   │
                    │   │                                     │
                    │   ├─ In-memory state                    │
                    │   │   positions, short_positions,       │
                    │   │   paper_cash, or_high/low, pdc,     │
                    │   │   _trading_halted, etc.             │
                    │   │                                     │
                    │   ├─ Signal bus  ──► Val / Gene ──► Alpaca
                    │   │   _emit_signal(event) async fan-out  │
                    │   │                                     │
                    │   └─ paper_state.py persistence         │
                    │       paper_state.json on Railway Volume │
                    │                                        |
                    │  dashboard_server.py (aiohttp)          │
                    │   ├─ /login, /api/state, /api/indices,   │
                    │   │  /api/executor/{val,gene},          │
                    │   │  /api/errors/{exec}, /stream (SSE)   │
                    │   ├─ /api/version (unauthenticated)       |
                    │   └─ static UI (dashboard_static/)       |
                    └──────────────┬──────────────────────────┘
                                   │
                                   │
        ┌──────────────────────────┼──────────────────────────┐
        ▼                          ▼                          ▼
   Alpaca Markets          Yahoo v8/chart            Telegram API
   (equity bars,           (cash indices             (commands +
    paper + live           ^GSPC/^IXIC/^DJI/          notifications,
    executors,             ^RUT/^VIX, futures         per-bot tokens)
    Val + Gene)            ES/NQ/YM/RTY)
```

Everything runs in a **single Python process** on Railway. Concurrency model:

- **Main thread** — Telegram async polling ( `python-telegram-bot==21.11.1` ).
- **`scheduler_thread`** — daemon thread, owns the 60 s scan cadence and the daily timed jobs ( `reset_daily_state` , `collect_or` , `eod_close` , …).
- **`dashboard-http`** — daemon thread with its own `asyncio` event loop running an `aiohttp` server on `DASHBOARD_PORT` (default 8080).
- **Per-executor Telegram apps** — Val and Gene each run their own `telegram.ext.Application` event loop (started by `TradeGeniusBase.start()` ).
- **Signal listeners** — each `_emit_signal(event)` fans out to listeners in **fresh daemon threads** so a slow Alpaca round-trip on one executor cannot stall the scanner.

## 2. Repo layout

```
trade_genius.py            # main bot; BOT_VERSION lives here
dashboard_server.py        # aiohttp dashboard backend (~1.9 kLOC)
dashboard_static/
    index.html             # single-page dashboard shell
    app.js                 # two IIFEs: main tab + Val/Gene tab + index ticker
    app.css                # tokens + responsive @media bands
side.py                    # Side enum + SideConfig table (long/short collapse)
paper_state.py             # paper book persistence (extracted in v4.6.0)
error_state.py             # per-executor error rings + dedup gate (v4.11.0)
tiger_buffalo_v5.py        # v5.0.0 Tiger/Buffalo state-machine helpers
volume_profile.py          # v5.1.0 Forensic Volume Filter (shadow only)
indicators.py              # v5.1.2 pure indicator math (rsi/ema/atr/vwap/spread)
bar_archive.py             # v5.1.2 1m bar JSONL persistence (/data/bars/)
telegram_commands.py       # slash-command handlers
smoke_test.py              # 220 local + 9 prod smoke tests
synthetic_harness/         # 50-scenario byte-equal replay harness
    runner.py, recorder.py, market.py, clock.py, scenarios/, goldens/
scripts/
    build_algo_pdf.py      # regenerates trade_genius_algo.pdf from this file
Dockerfile                 # explicit per-file COPY whitelist (see §11 Gotchas)
requirements.txt
railway.json, nixpacks.toml
.github/workflows/
    version-bump-check.yml # blocks PRs without BOT_VERSION + CHANGELOG bump
    post-deploy-smoke.yml  # runs smoke against tradegenius.up.railway.app
CHANGELOG.md               # full version history
COMMANDS.md                # full Telegram command reference
README.md
trade_genius_algo.pdf      # rendered architecture/algo doc
ARCHITECTURE.md            # this file
```

## 3. Process startup

`python trade_genius.py` (the `CMD` in the Dockerfile) does the following at module load:

1. Read environment variables (see §10).
2. `_init_tickers()` reads `TICKERS_FILE` (default `tickers.json`); falls back to `TICKERS_DEFAULT` if the file is missing or malformed. `TICKERS_PINNED = ("SPY", "QQQ")` is force-merged in.
3. `_validate_side_config_attrs()` asserts that every `*_attr` field on `SideConfig` (long + short) resolves to a real module-level global. Fail-fast import guard added in v4.9.2 — a renamed dict raises at load time instead of at first entry mid-session.
4. Optional: `dashboard_server.start_in_thread()` if `DASHBOARD_PASSWORD` is set (and ≥ 8 chars).
5. Optional: instantiate `TradeGeniusVal` and `TradeGeniusGene` if their `*_ENABLED` env vars are truthy and paper keys are present; each subscribes to the signal bus via `register_signal_listener`.
6. Start `scheduler_thread` as a daemon.
7. Boot the main Telegram `Application` and call `run_polling()`.

If `SSM_SMOKE_TEST=1` is set the file imports cleanly but skips the network-touching startup (used by `smoke_test.py` and the synthetic harness so they can `import trade_genius` without Telegram credentials).

---

## 4. Ticker universe

`TICKERS_DEFAULT` is **11 tickers**:

```
AAPL  MSFT  NVDA  TSLA  META  GOOG  AMZN  AVGO  QBTS  SPY  QQQ
```

- **9 spike candidates** — entries fire here.
- **2 pinned filter tickers** — `SPY` and `QQQ` are `TICKERS_PINNED`; they are read on every scan to gate entries by index polarity but are **never opened as positions** and cannot be removed via `/ticker remove`.

Edits go through `add_ticker()` / `remove_ticker()` (Telegram `/ticker add|remove`) which mutate the in-place `TICKERS` list and persist via `_save_tickers_file()` (atomic `.tmp` + `os.replace`). `TRADE_TICKERS` is rebuilt to mirror `TICKERS - TICKERS_PINNED` after every mutation. `TICKERS_MAX = 40` caps the universe so the per-cycle Yahoo budget stays bounded.

Symbol regex: `^[A-Z][A-Z0-9.\-]{0,7}$` (uppercase, US-equity-style; classes, ETFs, and common preferred-stock notations are accepted).

---

## 5. Scheduler & scan loop

### 5.1 Timed jobs ( `scheduler_thread` )

All times in **America/New_York** (ET); display in the UI is also ET. The trader views the ET clock as the trading clock; an internal display helper renders some Telegram cards in CDT to match the trader's home tz.

| Time | Day(s) | Job |
|---|---|---|
| 09:20 | Weekdays | System self-test card |
| 09:30 | Weekdays | `reset_daily_state()` — clear OR, daily counts |
| 09:31 | Weekdays | System self-test card |
| 09:35 | Weekdays | `collect_or()` (in its own thread) |
| 09:36 | Weekdays | `send_or_notification()` — OR card to Telegram |
| 15:55 | Weekdays | `eod_close()` — force-close all open positions |
| 15:58 | Weekdays | `send_eod_report()` |
| 18:00 | Sunday | `send_weekly_digest()` |

Idempotency: each fire is keyed by `YYYY-MM-DD-HH:MM-day-HH:MM`, kept in a `fired` set, and pruned to today's keys when it grows beyond 200 entries. The fire set is in-memory; a process restart re-fires any job whose minute the new instance lands inside.

### 5.2 Scan loop ( `scan_loop` )

`scheduler_thread` calls `scan_loop()` every `SCAN_INTERVAL = 60` s. The loop's structure:

1. `_refresh_market_mode()` — refresh the OPEN/CHOP/POWER/DEFENSIVE/CLOSED classifier *before* any early-return so the dashboard banner stays correct in after-hours too.
2. Skip if weekend, or before 09:35 ET, or after 15:55 ET (sets `_scan_idle_hours = True` for the dashboard's GATE pill).
3. `_clear_cycle_bar_cache()` — drop the per-cycle 1-minute bar cache.
4. **Regime alert** — re-evaluate `(SPY_cur > SPY_PDC) and (QQQ_cur > QQQ_PDC)`; on transition, fire a Telegram regime card.
5. `manage_positions()` — long stop chain + Red Candle + Lords Left.
6. `manage_short_positions()` — short stop chain + Bull Vacuum + Polarity Shift.
7. `_tiger_hard_eject_check()` — DI/regime hard-eject for open positions.
8. If `_scan_paused` is true (manual `/monitoring pause`), skip new entries; **position management still runs**.
9. For each `t` in `TRADE_TICKERS`: `_update_gate_snapshot(t)` → `check_entry(t)` → `execute_entry(t, px)` → `check_short_entry(t)` → `execute_short_entry(t, px)`.
10. Every exception inside steps 5–9 is wrapped in `report_error(...)` so it shows up in the per-executor health pill (§9.2) and the matching Telegram channel.

`save_paper_state()` runs **every 5 minutes** in its own daemon thread (driven by `last_state_save` in `scheduler_thread`).

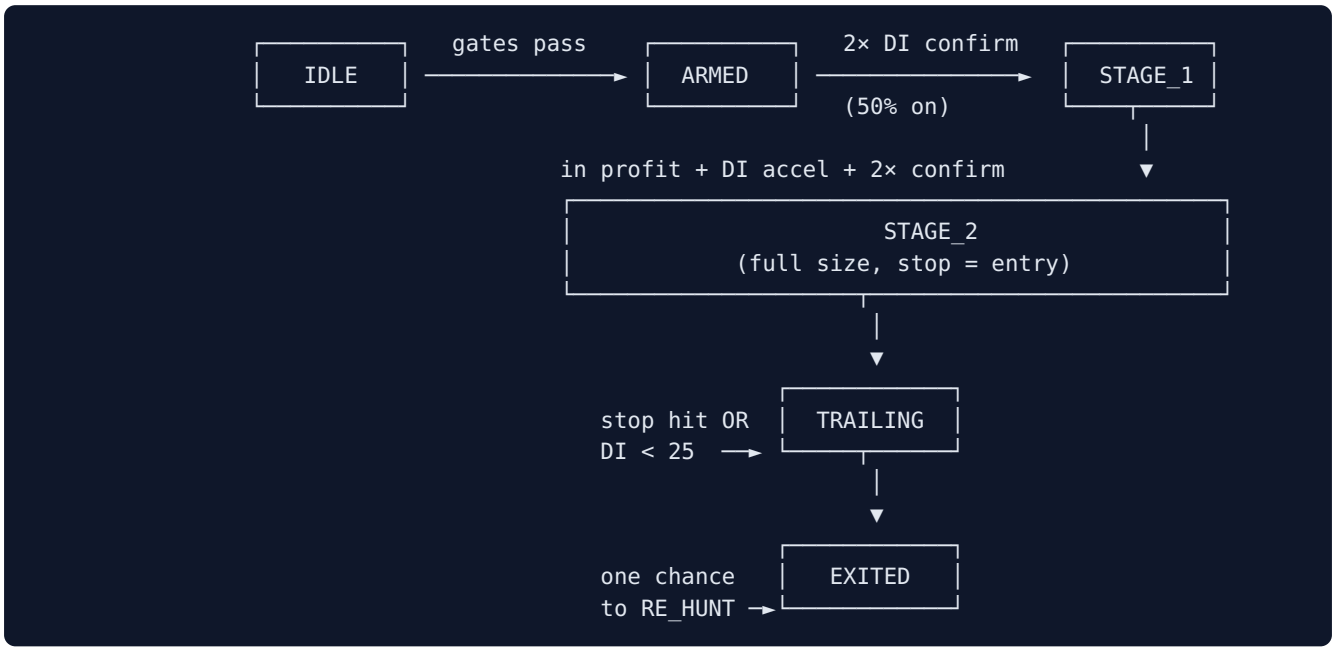
---

## 6. Trading algorithm — Tiger/Buffalo (v5.0.0, unchanged through v5.1.2)

> **Canonical spec:** `STRATEGY.md`. For any rule disagreement, the spec wins. Every code-level decision in `tiger_buffalo_v5.py` cites a rule ID (e.g. `L-P2-R3`) that maps 1:1 to the spec; smoke-test docstrings reference the same IDs.
>
> **v5.1.x is observation only.** v5.1.0 added the Forensic Volume Filter (§17) and v5.1.2 added the Forensic Capture layer (§18), but **neither one changes any Tiger/Buffalo entry, exit, sizing, or stop decision**. `VOL_GATE_ENFORCE` defaults to `0` and stays at `0` through v5.1.2. The synthetic harness 50/50 byte-equal goldens are still byte-equal under v5.1.2.

v5 reframes both long and short trades as a **two-stage entry, structural-ratchet exit** state machine. Per-ticker per-direction state lives in `trade_genius.v5_long_tracks` / `trade_genius.v5_short_tracks` (persisted in `paper_state.json`).

### 6.1 States




State enum: `IDLE`, `ARMED`, `STAGE_1`, `STAGE_2`, `TRAILING`, `EXITED`, `RE_HUNT_PENDING`, `LOCKED_FOR_DAY` (helpers in `tiger_buffalo_v5.py`).

### 6.2 Long protocol — "The Tiger Hunts the Bison"

| Phase | Rule IDs | Summary |
|---|---|---|
| **L-P1** | G1..G4 | Permission gates: QQQ > QQQ-PDC, SPY > SPY-PDC, ticker > ticker-PDC, ticker > first-hour high (09:30–10:30 ET). All four must be true to leave IDLE. |
| **L-P2** | R1..R5 | Stage-1 (50% on): `DI+(1m) > 25 AND DI+(5m) > 25` confirmed across **two consecutive closed 1m candles**. Initial stop = low of prior closed 5m candle (hard, does not move during STAGE_1). Record `original_entry_price`. |
| **L-P3** | R1..R5 | Stage-2 (full size): `DI+(1m) > 30` confirmed across two more consecutive closed 1m candles AND ticker last > original entry ("Winning Rule"). Add remaining 50%. **Safety Lock:** stop on entire 100% position moves to `original_entry_price` ("House Money"). |
| **L-P4** | R1..R4 | TRAILING: every 5m close, ratchet stop UP-ONLY to most recent Higher Low. Hard exits: `ticker.last < current_stop` OR `DI+(1m) < 25` on a closed 1m candle — either flattens 100%. |
| **L-P5** | R1..R3 | Re-Hunt (one shot): after exit, dormant until ticker > original entry ("reclamation"). On reclamation re-arm with FRESH values. After a second exit → `LOCKED_FOR_DAY`. |

### 6.3 Short protocol — "The Wounded Buffalo / Gravity Trade"

Structural mirror of the long side. The **priority-1 rule (S-P4-R3) inverts** vs. the long side: `DI−(1m) < 25` is checked BEFORE the structural-stop hit. Rationale (per spec): "fear moves faster than greed" — short-side momentum decay typically precedes a squeeze, so the bot covers on DI failure ahead of a stop trigger.

| Phase | Rule IDs | Summary |
|---|---|---|
| **S-P1** | G1..G4 | Gates: QQQ < PDC, SPY < PDC, ticker < PDC, ticker < opening-range-low (09:30–09:35 ET). If indices are GREEN, shorts are forbidden regardless of ticker weakness. |
| **S-P2** | R1..R5 | Stage-1 short (50% on): `DI−(1m) > 25 AND DI−(5m) > 25` confirmed × 2. Initial stop = high of prior closed 5m candle. |
| **S-P3** | R1..R5 | Stage-2: `DI−(1m) > 30` × 2 closed candles AND ticker last < original entry. Add remaining 50%. Safety Lock moves stop to `original_entry_price`. |
| **S-P4** | R1..R5 | TRAILING: ratchet stop DOWN-ONLY to most recent Lower High on each 5m close. **Priority-1 hard eject:** `DI−(1m) < 25` ⇒ immediate flatten BEFORE structural-stop check. **Priority-2:** `ticker.last > current_stop` ⇒ flatten. |
| **S-P5** | R1..R3 | Re-Hunt (one shot) on price reclaiming below original entry. Second exit ⇒ `LOCKED_FOR_DAY`. |

### 6.4 Sizing — preserved from v4

v5 changes how the position is **staged in** (50% then 50%), not how the unit is computed.

| Parameter | Value |
|---|---|
| Starting paper capital | $100,000.00 ( `PAPER_STARTING_CAPITAL` ) |
| Dollars per entry (paper) | `$10,000` ( `PAPER_DOLLARS_PER_ENTRY` env) — this is "100% of unit" |
| Stage-1 fill size | 50% of unit |
| Stage-2 fill size | remaining 50% |
| Shares per entry | `paper_shares_for(price)` (unchanged) |
| Order type | Limit at current market price |

Executor sizing is independent and per-executor: `VAL_DOLLARS_PER_ENTRY` and `GENE_DOLLARS_PER_ENTRY` (default $10,000 each). Each executor computes `max(1, int(dollars_per_entry // price))` from its own price reference at signal time. Per spec C-R7, SPY/QQQ are pinned filter rows on the dashboard and serve as L-P1-G1/G2 / S-P1-G1/G2 inputs; they are NEVER traded directly.

---

## 7. Risk: v5 stop model + portfolio brakes

> The v4 4-layer stop chain (structural baseline / 0.75% cap / breakeven ratchet / peak-anchored profit-lock ladder) has been **replaced** in v5 with the spec's two-stage stop model below. The v4 ladder math is preserved in source for the synthetic harness baselines but is no longer authoritative.

### 7.1 v5 per-trade stop model

The stop is a single value per track, evolved through three regimes:

1. **Stage-1 stop (L-P2-R4 / S-P2-R4) — "Emergency Exit."** Set to the low of the prior closed 5m candle (long) or the high of the prior closed 5m candle (short). Hard stop. Does NOT move while the track is in `STAGE_1`.
2. **Stage-2 safety lock (L-P3-R5 / S-P3-R5) — "House Money."** On the Stage-2 fill, the stop on the entire 100% position is moved to `original_entry_price`. The trade is now risk-free vs. its own cost basis.
3. **TRAILING ratchet (L-P4-R1..R2 / S-P4-R1..R2).** On each 5m close after Stage 2, compute the most recent Higher Low (long) or Lower High (short). Ratchet in the favorable direction only — the stop NEVER moves down on a long or up on a short. Implementation: `tiger_buffalo_v5.ratchet_long_higher_low` / `ratchet_short_lower_high`.

### 7.2 Hard exits (L-P4-R3 / S-P4-R3..R4)

| Side | Priority-1 (closed 1m candle) | Priority-2 (every tick) |
|---|---|---|
| Long | `DI+(1m) < 25` ⇒ flatten | `ticker.last < current_stop` |
| Short | `DI−(1m) < 25` ⇒ flatten | `ticker.last > current_stop` |

**Short side inverts ordering** per S-P4-R3: the DI<25 hard eject is priority-1 over the structural-stop check. This is the single most important behavioral asymmetry between the two protocols and is covered by a dedicated smoke test ( `v5 S-P4-R3: short DI<25 hard eject fires PRIORITY-1 over structural stop` ). Long side: either trigger flattens, order is observability-only.

### 7.3 Re-Hunt budget (L-P5-R3 / S-P5-R3)

After an exit the track lands in `EXITED` with the re-hunt budget unspent. On reclamation (price climbs back above original entry for longs, below for shorts), the state machine returns to `ARMED` with all stage counters reset and `original_entry_price = None`. After a second exit the track is forced to `LOCKED_FOR_DAY` regardless of subsequent reclamations.

### 7.4 Portfolio-level brakes — preserved from v4

Spec section C documents the cross-cutting rules; v5 wires each into the existing v4 helpers so the brakes still fire even when the v5 state machine is mid-trade.

| Spec | Brake | Implementation |
|---|---|---|
| C-R4 | Daily-loss-limit (incl. v4.7.0 short-side cap) | `_check_daily_loss_limit()` flips `_trading_halted=True` AND calls `v5_lock_all_tracks("daily_loss_limit")` so every track moves to `LOCKED_FOR_DAY`. |
| C-R5 | EOD force-close at 15:55 ET | `eod_close()` walks `positions` + `short_positions` flattening every open paper position, then calls `v5_lock_all_tracks("eod")` so the next session starts fresh rather than resuming. |
| C-R6 | Sovereign Regime Shield (Eye of the Tiger) | `_sovereign_regime_eject()` — preserved unchanged. When active, all gates are forced false and any open position is flattened. |
| C-R7 | 9-ticker spike universe + SPY/QQQ pinned | `TRADE_TICKERS` is the 9-name spike list (excludes SPY/QQQ). `check_breakout` reads SPY/QQQ as polarity inputs only. |

`DAILY_LOSS_LIMIT` (default −$500, env-tunable). Once today's realized P&L crosses the floor, `/api/state` exposes `_trading_halted_reason` so the dashboard's GATE pill paints `HALTED`. Both long and short honor the limit (the v4.7.0 fix is preserved).

---

## 8. Signal bus & executors

### 8.1 The bus

`_signal_listeners: list[Callable]` plus `_signal_listeners_lock` (a `threading.Lock`). `register_signal_listener(fn)` is idempotent — a re-registration is a no-op so a supervisor restart of an executor cannot double-fire entries against Alpaca.

`_emit_signal(event)` snapshots the listener list under the lock, spawns a fresh daemon thread per listener, and returns immediately. Per-listener exceptions are caught and logged but never propagated.

Event schema:

```
{
    "kind":         "ENTRY_LONG" | "ENTRY_SHORT" | "EXIT_LONG" |
                    "EXIT_SHORT" | "EOD_CLOSE_ALL",
    "ticker":       "AAPL",        # absent on EOD_CLOSE_ALL
    "price":        175.42,        # main's reference price
    "reason":       "BREAKOUT" | "STOP" | "TRAIL" | "RED_CANDLE" |
                    "LORDS_LEFT" | "BULL_VACUUM" | "POLARITY_SHIFT" |
                    "EOD" | "HARD_EJECT_TIGER" | ... ,
    "timestamp_utc":"2026-04-24T13:45:12Z",
    "main_shares":  57,            # audit: shares the paper book traded
}
```

## 8.2 Executors: TradeGeniusVal & TradeGeniusGene

Both subclass a shared `TradeGeniusBase`. Behavior lives in the base; the subclasses only set `NAME` and `ENV_PREFIX`.

| Executor | Name | Env prefix |
|---|---|---|
| `TradeGeniusVal` | Val | `VAL_` |
| `TradeGeniusGene` | Gene | `GENE_` |

Per-executor knobs (read at instance construction):

- `*_ALPACA_PAPER_KEY` / `*_ALPACA_PAPER_SECRET`
- `*_ALPACA_LIVE_KEY` / `*_ALPACA_LIVE_SECRET`
- `*_TELEGRAM_TG` (token) / `*_TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID`
- `*_DOLLARS_PER_ENTRY` (default `$10,000`)
- `*_ENABLED` (default on; set to `0` to skip startup)

The owner whitelist is **shared with main** via `TRADEGENIUS_OWNER_IDS` — there are no per-executor `VAL_TELEGRAM_OWNER_IDS` or `GENE_TELEGRAM_OWNER_IDS` (those names appear in `.env.example` for historical readers but the code uses the unified set). Default value: `5165570192,167005578` (Val + Gene).

**Routing (clarified in v5.0.3).** Each executor's *own* Telegram bot fans trade confirmations out to every learned owner-id → chat-id pair. In other words: Val's trades land on Val's bot, Gene's trades land on Gene's bot, but **every owner sees every executor's confirmations on that executor's bot** because the owner whitelist is shared. Each owner must DM their executor bot once (any message) so the auto-learn hook records the chat_id; the map is persisted at `/data/executor_chats_{name}.json` and survives Railway redeploys (see §11.6). No per-executor `<PREFIX>TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID` env var is required — it is accepted only as a back-compat seed.

**Paper/live Alpaca key independence (v5.0.4).** Each executor reads its paper credentials from **only** `<PREFIX>ALPACA_PAPER_KEY` / `<PREFIX>ALPACA_PAPER_SECRET` and its live credentials from **only** `<PREFIX>ALPACA_LIVE_KEY` / `<PREFIX>ALPACA_LIVE_SECRET`. There is no fallback from paper to live (or vice versa). v5.0.3 briefly added a fallback from `<PREFIX>ALPACA_PAPER_KEY` to `<PREFIX>ALPACA_KEY` (the un-prefixed name); v5.0.4 reverted it after Val confirmed `GENE_ALPACA_KEY` on Railway is a LIVE key. Operators provisioning a new executor must mint a fresh paper key from a paper Alpaca account and set the paper-prefixed env var — never repurpose un-prefixed keys. See §11.7 for the full incident write-up.

State files (one per mode, per executor):

```
tradegenius_val_paper.json     tradegenius_val_live.json
tradegenius_gene_paper.json    tradegenius_gene_live.json
```

`_load_state()` picks the most-recently-written file so a live restart stays in live; mode flips rebuild the Alpaca client through `_build_alpaca_client(mode=...)`.

### 8.3 Live mode flip

`set_mode("live", confirm_token)` requires:

1. `confirm_token == "confirm"` (i.e. the operator typed `/mode val live confirm`).
2. `_live_sanity_check()` — build a temp live `TradingClient`, call `get_account()`, verify status contains `ACTIVE`. Logs account number / cash / buying power.

If either gate fails, the mode does not flip and the bot replies with the error reason. Paper flips have no token gate.

### 8.4 Alpaca client URL hygiene

`alpaca-py 0.43.2`'s `RESTClient` builds the final URL as `base_url + "/" + api_version + path`, i.e. it always appends `/v2`. `url_override` therefore must be a **host** (e.g. `https://paper-api.alpaca.markets`) — not a host-with-`/v2`. `_build_alpaca_client` defensively strips trailing `/v2` or `/v2/` so a misconfigured `ALPACA_ENDPOINT_PAPER` or `ALPACA_ENDPOINT_TRADE` env var cannot produce double-prefixed URLs.

---

## 9. Dashboard

### 9.1 Backend (`dashboard_server.py`)

`aiohttp` server, runs in a daemon thread with its own asyncio loop.

| Endpoint | Auth | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| `GET /` | cookie or login page | Dashboard SPA ( `dashboard_static/index.html` ) |
| `POST /login` | rate-limited (5/min/IP) | Form-encoded password; sets HMAC token cookie |
| `POST /logout` | cookie | Clears `spike_session` cookie |
| `GET /api/state` | cookie | Aggregate snapshot: portfolio, positions, trades, gates, regime, errors |
| `GET /api/version` | **none** | Returns `{"version": BOT_VERSION}` — used by the post-deploy poller |
| `GET /api/indices` | cookie | SPY/QQQ/DIA/IWM/VIX (Alpaca) + ^GSPC/^IXIC/^DJI/^RUT/^VIX (Yahoo) + futures badges |
| `GET /api/executor/{name}` | cookie | Per-executor tab data; cached 15 s |
| `GET /api/errors/{executor}` | cookie | Health-pill expanded list (last 10) |
| `GET /api/trade_log` | cookie | Persistent trade-log tail; supports `limit` , `since` , `portfolio` |
| `GET /stream` | cookie | Server-Sent Events; pushes a state snapshot every 2 s |
| `GET /static/*` | none | Served from `dashboard_static/` |

Auth: HMAC-SHA256 token stored in `spike_session` cookie. Token = `hex(HMAC(secret, BE-uint64-timestamp)) + ":" + ts` . The secret is generated once on first boot and persisted to `dashboard_secret.key` on the Railway Volume so re-deploys do not invalidate sessions (v3.4.29). Override via `DASHBOARD_SESSION_SECRET` for tests / forced rotation. Cookie attrs: `HttpOnly; SameSite=Lax; Secure=True; Max-Age=7d` .

`_check_auth()` validates timestamp + HMAC on every authenticated endpoint. POST `/login` enforces a per-IP in-memory rate limit (5 attempts per 60 s window).

State snapshot caching:

- `_cached_snapshot()` — TTL cache of `snapshot()` (~10 s) shared across SSE clients. v4.1.9-dash so concurrent dashboards do not each pay `O(N_positions)` Alpaca round-trips every 2 s.
- `_indices_cache` — 30 s TTL on `_fetch_indices()` (one Yahoo batch per cache miss; ETF prices come from Alpaca via the executor's data client).
- `_executor_cache` — 15 s TTL per `(executor_name)` .

### 9.2 Index ticker (v4.10 → v4.13.0)

The strip at the top of the dashboard now carries **two stacked sources**:

**Alpaca ETF rows** (5):

```
SPY  QQQ  DIA  IWM  VIX
```

`_fetch_indices()` calls `client.get_stock_snapshot(StockSnapshotRequest(...))` on the first available executor's paper keys ( `_resolve_data_client` ). `VIX` is requested separately and tagged with `reason="vix_no_equity_feed"` because Alpaca's equity feed does not carry the volatility index symbol — its row stays as a sentinel placeholder.

**Yahoo cash + futures rows** (5):

```
^GSPC (S&P 500)   [ES +0.40%]
^IXIC (Nasdaq)    [NQ +0.32%]
^DJI  (Dow)       [YM +0.18%]
^RUT  (Russell 2K)[RTY −0.05%]
^VIX  (VIX)       (no future badge — VX=F is on CFE)
```

`_fetch_yahoo_quote_one(symbol)` hits

```
https://query1.finance.yahoo.com/v8/finance/chart/<URL-ENC(symbol)>?
    interval=1m&range=1d&includePrePost=true
```

with the caret/equals URL-encoded ( `^→%5E` , `=→%3D` ) so `^GSPC` and `ES=F` both round-trip cleanly. `_fetch_yahoo_quotes(symbols)` fans out across a `ThreadPoolExecutor(max_workers=8)` with a per-request `timeout=6` seconds, so the 9-symbol batch (5 cash + 4 futures) completes in ≈ one request's wall-clock instead of 9 sequential.

The futures badge `[ES +0.40%]` is computed from the future's *own* percent move vs. the future's *own* previous close — not from last-cash vs. future-prev — so the badge tells the trader *where futures are pricing the next session's open*, which is the entire reason to show futures. `^VIX` has no entry in `_YAHOO_INDEX_FUTURE` so its row never paints a badge.

If the Yahoo batch returns **zero** symbols (whole-batch failure), the payload sets `yahoo_ok=false` and `yahoo_error=...` ; the frontend prepends a dim `data delayed` chip while keeping every Alpaca ETF row live ("degrade, don't disappear"). A *partial* miss (e.g. `^RUT` flickering for one cache window) silently omits the missing row.

Session classification — `_classify_session_et()` returns one of `rth | pre | post | closed` from `America/New_York` :

- Weekday `04:00–09:30 ET` → `pre`
- Weekday `09:30–16:00 ET` → `rth`
- Weekday `16:00–20:00 ET` → `post`
- Otherwise (incl. weekends) → `closed`

Used by the frontend AH layer on ETF rows: outside RTH the row paints an extra `AH +0.42 +0.06%` (or `PRE …` ) chip in the AH delta's own color (independent of the regular-session change's color). The backend's `_fetch_indices()` returns `marketState=None` from Yahoo's metadata, which is why we classify session locally instead of trusting the upstream field.

### 9.3 Frontend ( `dashboard_static/` )

Single HTML file, two independent IIFEs in `app.js`:

1. **Main dashboard IIFE** (≈ lines 1–797). Owns the `/api/state` poller, `/stream` SSE consumer, KPI rendering, position table, trade table, GATE/Regime/Session pills, `applyGateTriState()`, `__tgApplyHealthPill()`, brand-row clock, LIVE pill, recycle countdown.
2. **Tabs + executors IIFE** (≈ lines 799–1632). Owns the Main/Val/Gene tab switcher, per-executor `/api/executor/{name}` poller (15 s), and the index ticker strip `/api/indices` poller (30 s) including marquee animation.

The two IIFEs communicate via `window.__tgApplyGateTriState` and `window.__tgApplyHealthPill` — explicit named bridges added in v4.10.2 when `Fetch failed` banners surfaced from cross-IIFE access.

**LIVE pill (v4.11.5).** `#h-tick` always renders `♻ NN` s where `NN` is the seconds to the next scan, or `♻ --` when the backend has no schedule (weekend / scanner idle). The 1 s `streamTickTimer` interval decrements `__nextScanSec` if numeric and unconditionally calls `updateNextScanLabel()`. `#h-tick` is **never** hidden — Val's hard rule preserved across every mobile band.

**Index marquee (v4.12.0).** After each `renderIndices()` the JS measures `track.scrollWidth` vs `strip.clientWidth`; on overflow it adds `.idx-marquee` to the strip and **duplicates** the inner items so the CSS `translateX(0 → -50%)` keyframe loops seamlessly. Pause is applied on `:hover`, `:focus-within`, and a tap-to-toggle `.is-paused` class. The whole thing is gated by `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce` which falls back to native `overflow-x: auto`.

**Health pill (v4.11.0).** Replaced the noisy log-tail card. Tap to expand the last 10 events. Three tiers driven by `error_state.snapshot()`:

- `green` — count == 0
- `warning` (amber) — count > 0 AND no error/critical events today
- `red` — any error or critical event today

Errors fan out to the matching executor's Telegram channel via `report_error()` with a per-`(executor, code)` 5-minute dedup gate (see `error_state.py`). Daily counts reset inside `reset_daily_state()`.

**CSS breakpoints ( `dashboard_static/app.css` ):** `@media (max-width: 500/400/380/360 px)` for the mobile cascade; an additional `900 / 640 px` band for sidebar/grid collapse and the index-strip "compact" mode that drops the absolute Δ$ value so 5 items fit on a 390-px iPhone horizontally.

---

## 10. Environment variables

Dumped from `os.getenv` / `os.environ` in `trade_genius.py` and `dashboard_server.py`.

### 10.1 Required

| Variable | Used by | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `TELEGRAM_TOKEN` | main bot | `@BotFather` token for the main TradeGenius bot |
| `CHAT_ID` | main bot | Group/channel id (negative for groups) |

### 10.2 Owner whitelist

| Variable | Default | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `TRADEGENIUS_OWNER_IDS` | `5165570192` | Comma-separated Telegram user ids; group=-1 TypeHandler |
| | | drops non-owners silently. Renamed from |
| | | `RH_OWNER_USER_IDS` in v3.6.0 — old name no longer read |

Production typically sets this to `"5165570192,167005578"` (Val + Gene).

### 10.3 Market data

| Variable | Default | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `FMP_API_KEY` | hard-coded fallback (free key) | PDC + quote data |
| `FINNHUB_TOKEN` | empty | Optional secondary quote path |

### 10.4 Persistence (Railway Volume)

| Variable | Default | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `PAPER_STATE_PATH` | `paper_state.json` | Set to `/data/...` on Railway |
| `PAPER_LOG_PATH` | `investment.log` | Trade log file path ( `paper_log()` ) |
| `TRADE_LOG_FILE` | (derived) | Append-only `.jsonl` for full trade log |
| `TICKERS_FILE` | `tickers.json` | Editable ticker universe |

### 10.5 Risk / strategy

| Variable | Default | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `DAILY_LOSS_LIMIT` | `-500` | Halt new entries when realized P&L ≤ floor |
| `OR_WINDOW_MINUTES` | `5` | Width of the opening range (used for premarket seed) |
| `OR_STALE_THRESHOLD` | `0.05` | OR vs live drift before entry skip (5%) |
| `ENTRY_EXTENSION_MAX_PCT` | `1.5` | Max % entry can extend past OR trigger |
| `ENTRY_STOP_CAP_REJECT` | `1` | Reject entries that would need the 0.75% cap to fire |
| `TIGER_V2_DI_THRESHOLD` | `25` | DI+/− floor on resampled 5-min bars |
| `TIGER_V2_REQUIRE_VOL` | `false` | Optional volume confirmation for Tiger v2 |
| `PAPER_DOLLARS_PER_ENTRY` | `10000` | Dollar size per paper entry |
| `DI_PREMARKET_SEED` | `1` | Include premarket bars in startup DI seed |

### 10.6 Dashboard

| Variable | Default | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `DASHBOARD_PASSWORD` | unset | If unset, dashboard does **not** start. Min 8 chars. |
| `DASHBOARD_PORT` | `8080` | aiohttp listen port |
| `DASHBOARD_SESSION_SECRET` | unset | Override the persisted `dashboard_secret.key` HMAC key |
| `DASHBOARD_TRUST_PROXY` | unset | Set to `1` behind Railway / Cloudflare for client-IP |

### 10.7 Executors (Val / Gene)

Each executor uses the prefix below; replace `{P}` with `VAL_` or `GENE_`. Paper and live keys are **strictly independent** — paper mode reads only `<PREFIX>ALPACA_PAPER_KEY` / `<PREFIX>ALPACA_PAPER_SECRET`, live mode reads only `<PREFIX>ALPACA_LIVE_KEY` / `<PREFIX>ALPACA_LIVE_SECRET`. No fallback. (v5.0.4 reverted the brief v5.0.3 paper→un-prefixed fallback; see §11.7.)

| Variable | Default | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `{P}ENABLED` | `1` | Set to `0` (or `false`) to skip startup |
| `{P}ALPACA_PAPER_KEY` | empty | Paper-only Alpaca key. Required to start in paper mode. |
| `{P}ALPACA_PAPER_SECRET` | empty | Paper-only secret. |
| `{P}ALPACA_LIVE_KEY` | empty | Live-only key. Required only to flip live. |
| `{P}ALPACA_LIVE_SECRET` | empty | Live-only secret. |
| `{P}TELEGRAM_TG` | empty | Per-executor Telegram bot token |
| `{P}TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID` | empty | v5.0.3: optional seed only (auto-learn fills the map) |
| `{P}EXECUTOR_CHATS_PATH` | `/data/executor_chats_{name}.json` | v5.0.3 auto-learned chat-map |
| `{P}DOLLARS_PER_ENTRY` | `10000` | Dollar size per executor entry |
| `ALPACA_ENDPOINT_PAPER` | unset | URL host override (no `/v2`); shared by both executors |
| `ALPACA_ENDPOINT_TRADE` | unset | URL host override (no `/v2`); shared by both executors |

**Production Railway naming (as of v5.1.2).**

- Val executor — paper. `VAL_ALPACA_PAPER_KEY` (26 chars) and `VAL_ALPACA_PAPER_SECRET` (44 chars) are set on Railway from Val's paper Alpaca account. Val executor starts in paper mode at boot.
- Gene executor — currently NOT booting paper. `GENE_ALPACA_KEY` / `GENE_ALPACA_SECRET` exist on Railway but are **LIVE** keys, and the paper-prefixed names ( `GENE_ALPACA_PAPER_KEY` / `GENE_ALPACA_PAPER_SECRET` ) are unset — so the executor startup gate correctly logs `[Gene] skipped (GENE_ALPACA_PAPER_KEY set=False)` and skips. To bring Gene up in paper mode, mint a fresh paper key from Gene's paper Alpaca account and set the paper-prefixed names; do NOT rename the existing live keys.

### 10.8 Forensic Volume Filter (v5.1.0+)

| Variable | Default | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `VOL_GATE_ENFORCE` | `0` | Master enforcement flag. Stays `0` through v5.1.2 (shadow only). |
| `VOL_GATE_TICKER_ENABLED` | `1` | Active config: anchor on per-ticker volume gate. |
| `VOL_GATE_INDEX_ENABLED` | `1` | Active config: anchor on QQQ "Market Tide" gate. |
| `VOL_GATE_TICKER_PCT` | `70` | Active-config ticker threshold (percent of ToD avg). |
| `VOL_GATE_QQQ_PCT` | `100` | Active-config QQQ threshold (percent of ToD avg). |
| `VOL_GATE_INDEX_SYMBOL` | `QQQ` | Hard-locked to QQQ per Val. |
| `VOLUME_PROFILE_DIR` | `/data/volume_profiles` | Per-ticker baseline JSONs. |

Defaults preserve the v5.1.1 Apr 20-24 backtest-recommended thresholds. The four `SHADOW_CONFIGS` (TICKER+QQQ, TICKER_ONLY, QQQ_ONLY, GEMINI_A) are **not** env-driven — they are hard-coded module constants in `volume_profile.py`; env vars only control which one would gate trades if `VOL_GATE_ENFORCE=1`. See §17 for details.

### 10.9 Testing

| Variable | Default | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `SSM_SMOKE_TEST` | unset | When `=1`, skips the network-touching startup at import time |

### 10.10 Do not set

`TZ` — the bot uses `zoneinfo` and `pytz` internally; setting this breaks scheduling. Documented in `.env.example`.

---

## 11. Known gotchas

### 11.1 Dockerfile per-file COPY whitelist

`Dockerfile` does **not** `COPY . .` — it explicitly copies each top-level Python module:

```
COPY trade_genius.py .
COPY telegram_commands.py .
COPY paper_state.py .
COPY side.py .
COPY error_state.py .
COPY tiger_buffalo_v5.py .   # v5.0.0
COPY volume_profile.py .     # v5.1.0
COPY indicators.py .         # v5.1.2
COPY bar_archive.py .        # v5.1.2
COPY dashboard_server.py .
COPY dashboard_static/ ./dashboard_static/
```

**Footgun.** Any new top-level Python module must be added to this whitelist in the same PR or the container crashes on boot with `ModuleNotFoundError`. v4.11.0 shipped `error_state.py` without the matching `COPY` line and prod stayed 502 for ~3 hours ( `v4.11.1` was the one-line fix). v5.0.0 shipped `tiger_buffalo_v5.py` with the same omission and prod was again 502 until `v5.0.2`. v5.0.2 added a CI infra-guard test ( `smoke_test.py: infra: Dockerfile COPY whitelist includes every top-level imported module` ) that parses every `import` / `from` line in `trade_genius.py`, intersects against local `.py` modules, and grep-extracts the `COPY <module>.py` directives in the Dockerfile — any missing entry fails CI before merge. v5.1.0 added `COPY volume_profile.py` and v5.1.2 added `COPY indicators.py` and `COPY bar_archive.py` per this guard.

`COPY tickers.json` is intentionally absent — the file lives on the Railway Volume ( `TICKERS_FILE=/data/tickers.json` ) and is created at runtime by `_save_tickers_file()`.

### 11.2 Yahoo "real-time" is not real-time

Yahoo's `v8/finance/chart` endpoint returns delayed quotes (typically ~15 minutes for cash indices). The dashboard treats the cash + futures rows as *informational* — the bot never trades off Yahoo data; entries and stop management run off the Alpaca / FMP feed. The frontend's `data delayed` chip is the operator-facing signal that the Yahoo fallback engaged for the *whole batch*.

### 11.3 `marketState` is `None`

Yahoo's chart-endpoint metadata `marketState` field comes back `null` on most responses regardless of session. The dashboard intentionally does **not** trust it; `_classify_session_et()` derives the session from the local `America/New_York` clock instead.

### 11.4 Dashboard is read-only

By design, no dashboard endpoint mutates bot state, places orders, or toggles anything. Every shared-state read is best-effort and silent on failure ( `_safe(fn, default)` ); a dashboard exception cannot tank the bot.

### 11.5 Don't import `trade_genius` from helper threads

`trade_genius.py` is the program's `__main__`; doing a fresh `import trade_genius` from another thread re-executes the module top level (which calls `loop.add_signal_handler(...)` from a non-main thread and crashes). `dashboard_server._ssm()` resolves the live module via `sys.modules['__main__']` first; helper modules ( `paper_state.py`, `telegram_commands.py` ) follow the same pattern.

### 11.6 Executor trade-confirmation DM (v5.0.3 auto-learn)

Each executor's Telegram bot ships its trade confirmations via `_send_own_telegram`, which fans out to a learned `owner_id -> chat_id` map persisted at `/data/executor_chats_{name}.json` (path overridable via `<PREFIX>EXECUTOR_CHATS_PATH`). The map is populated transparently on the existing `_auth_guard` choke point — any inbound DM from an owner registers that owner's chat_id, atomically writes to disk, and survives Railway redeploys. **No `<PREFIX>TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID` env var is required** (it's accepted as a back-compat seed only). If the map is empty at signal time, the bot logs once at startup (`[Val] notifications EMPTY — DM this executor's bot /start ...`) and silently skips that signal — the trade still hits Alpaca, but the operator must DM the bot once to enable confirmations. This is the bug v5.0.3 fixed; pre-5.0.3 the executor silently dropped every confirmation when `TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID` was unset on Railway.

### 11.7 Paper and live Alpaca keys are independent (v5.0.4 revert)

Alpaca paper keys and live (real-money) keys are independent credentials issued against different endpoints. They are **not** interchangeable and must **never** be silently substituted for one another. v5.0.3 briefly added a fallback in `TradeGeniusBase.__init__` that read `<PREFIX>ALPACA_PAPER_KEY` and fell back to `<PREFIX>ALPACA_KEY` if the paper key was unset; v5.0.4 reverted that fallback after Val confirmed `GENE_ALPACA_KEY` on Railway is a LIVE key. Had Gene's executor instantiated under v5.0.3, paper-mode orders would have been routed through live credentials. The correct contract — enforced both by `__init__` (v5.0.4 strict reads) and the executor startup gate at module scope — is that paper mode reads **only** `<PREFIX>ALPACA_PAPER_KEY` / `<PREFIX>ALPACA_PAPER_SECRET`, and live mode reads **only** `<PREFIX>ALPACA_LIVE_KEY` / `<PREFIX>ALPACA_LIVE_SECRET`. Operators provisioning a new executor must set the paper-prefixed env vars from a paper Alpaca account; do not repurpose un-prefixed keys, which by repo convention are the live-account credentials.

---

## 12. Persistence

`paper_state.json` is written atomically (write to `.tmp`, then `os.replace`) every 5 minutes during `scan_loop()` and on graceful shutdown signals. Key fields:

```
{
  "paper_cash": 97543.21,
  "positions": {
    "NVDA": {
      "entry_price": 142.50, "shares": 70, "entry_count": 1,
      "stop": 141.44, "initial_stop": 141.23,
      "trail_high": 143.80, "trail_active": true,
      "entry_time": "2026-04-24T13:42:11Z"
    }
  },
  "short_positions": { "...": "..." },
  "paper_trades":     [ "...today's trades..." ],
  "paper_all_trades": [ "...all trades, capped at 500..." ],
  "daily_entry_count":       { "NVDA": 1 },
  "daily_short_entry_count": { "NVDA": 0 },
  "or_high": { "NVDA": 142.10, "...": "..." },
  "or_low":  { "...": "..." },
  "pdc":     { "SPY": 565.30, "QQQ": 480.18, "...": "..." },
  "_trading_halted": false,
  "_trading_halted_reason": "",
  "bot_version": "4.13.0"
}
```

A separate append-only `trade_log.jsonl` (path resolved by `TRADE_LOG_FILE`) logs every entry/exit with full context — the dashboard's `/api/trade_log` reads its tail.

Unknown fields on disk (e.g. legacy `avwap_data`, `avwap_last_ts`) are silently ignored on load so old state files survive code purges.

---

## 13. Testing

### 13.1 Local smoke (`smoke_test.py`)

**220/220 tests** at v5.1.2 (was 161 at v5.0.4, 181 at v5.1.0, 194 at v5.1.1). Tests are grouped via the `@t(name)` decorator. Runs on every PR via `.github/workflows/post-deploy-smoke.yml` (after the prod rollout poll succeeds). Coverage spans the trade-decision arithmetic (stop-chain layers, breakeven ratchet, ladder tiers, entry-extension guard), data helpers (`_classify_session_et`, `_or_price_sane`), state I/O (`paper_state.save/load/reset`), the index payload schema, the Yahoo helper API surface, the v5 Tiger/Buffalo rule grid (every `L-P*-R*` / `S-P*-R*` / `C-R*` rule has at least one test docstring citing the rule ID), the v5.0.2 Dockerfile COPY infra-guard, the v5.0.3 chat-map auto-learn / fan-out, the v5.0.4 paper-key strict read, the v5.1.0 `[VOLPROFILE]` section (calendar helpers, `session_bucket` boundaries, `evaluate_g4` PASS/BLOCK paths, disable-on-30-symbol cap, JSON round-trip), the v5.1.1 env-driven A/B toggles + 3-config `SHADOW_CONFIGS` parallel emit, and the v5.1.2 forensic capture additions (4-tuple `SHADOW_CONFIGS` with `GEMINI_A` at 110/85, 4 `[CFG=...]` lines per candidate, `bar_archive.write_bar` + `cleanup_old_dirs`, `indicators.rsi14` / `ema9` / `ema21` / `atr14` / `vwap_dist_pct` / `spread_bps` happy-path + insufficient-bars-returns-None, and emitter-format tests for `[V510-MINUTE]` / `[V510-CAND]` / `[V510-FSM]` / `[V510-ENTRY]`), plus a handful of dashboard-route contract tests against a stub aiohttp app.

### 13.2 Synthetic harness ( `synthetic_harness/` )

50 named, byte-equal-replay scenarios under `synthetic_harness/scenarios/{long_entries, short_entries, long_closes, short_closes, scan_loops, edge_cases}.py` with goldens under `synthetic_harness/goldens/*.json`. CLI:

```
python -m synthetic_harness list
python -m synthetic_harness record <scenario>
python -m synthetic_harness replay <scenario>
python -m synthetic_harness diff   <scenario>
```

Each scenario seeds module state through `_reset_module_state`, drives the bot through a `FrozenClock` and `SyntheticMarket`, and records `OutputRecorder` events. `replay_scenario()` strips `trade_genius_version` from both the observed and golden dicts before compare (v4.11.5), so a `BOT_VERSION` bump alone never invalidates all 50 goldens. `record_scenario()` still stamps the current version into freshly-recorded goldens.

`smoke_test.py --synthetic` lifts the local smoke total by replaying all 50 goldens. **v5.1.0 / v5.1.1 / v5.1.2 are observation-only**, so the 50/50 byte-equal still passes after each release without re-record.

### 13.3 CI guards

- **`version-bump-check.yml`** — blocks PRs to `main` unless **both** `BOT_VERSION` in `trade_genius.py` and the top `##` heading in `CHANGELOG.md` change in the diff. **Escape hatch:** include the literal token `[skip-version]` anywhere in the PR title or body. Use it only for docs-only / CI-only changes.
- **`post-deploy-smoke.yml`** — fires on every push to `main`. Polls `/api/version` against `https://tradegenius.up.railway.app` until the new `BOT_VERSION` is live (or times out at 5 min), then runs the full smoke suite. v4.11.4 repointed `DASHBOARD_URL` here from the pre-rename Railway domain that had been 404'ing since v3.5.1.

---

## 14. Deployment

### 14.1 Railway

1. Connect the GitHub repo. Railway auto-builds and deploys on every push to `main` ( `railway.json` + `nixpacks.toml` ; Docker builder is the canonical path via `Dockerfile` ).
2. Attach a Railway Volume; mount it at `/data`.
3. Set the env vars listed in §10. At minimum: `TELEGRAM_TOKEN`, `CHAT_ID`, `TRADEGENIUS_OWNER_IDS`, `DASHBOARD_PASSWORD`, plus the executor key sets you want active.
4. Verify rollout via `https://tradegenius.up.railway.app/api/version`.

### 14.2 Local development

```
python3 -m venv .venv && source .venv/bin/activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
cp .env.example .env  # then edit
DASHBOARD_PASSWORD=devpassword python trade_genius.py
```

Smoke tests against the running local instance:

```
DASHBOARD_URL=http://localhost:8080 \
DASHBOARD_PASSWORD=devpassword \
python smoke_test.py --local --prod
```

### 14.3 Logging

Dual handler: file ( `trade_genius.log` ) + stdout. All stdout/stderr is visible in the Railway dashboard. Errors that go through `report_error()` also fan out to the matching executor's Telegram channel (with a 5-minute per-`(executor, code)` dedup) and increment the dashboard health pill's per-executor count.

---

## 15. Maintenance

### 15.1 Regenerating `trade_genius_algo.pdf`

```
pip install weasyprint
python scripts/build_algo_pdf.py
```

The script renders this `ARCHITECTURE.md` plus a cover page and table-of-contents into `trade_genius_algo.pdf` at the repo root. Re-run it after any architecture change you want reflected in the PDF; commit the regenerated binary in the same PR. The script is intentionally a single file with no project-specific dependencies beyond `weasyprint` and the markdown source so it survives module renames.

### 15.2 Bumping `BOT_VERSION`

Bump the constant on line 61 of `trade_genius.py` AND prepend a `## v{N} — YYYY-MM-DD — <one-line summary>` heading at the top of `CHANGELOG.md`. The CI `version-bump-required` job blocks the PR otherwise. For **docs-only** or **CI-only** PRs (this one included), leave `BOT_VERSION` alone and put `[skip-version]` in the PR title.

### 15.3 Adding a new top-level Python module

Always add a matching `COPY <name>.py .` line to the `Dockerfile`. The container will not pick the file up otherwise and will crash on boot. (See §11.1.)

### 15.4 Reading the live state without restarting

Every piece of bot state is reachable through the dashboard's `/api/state`, `/api/executor/{name}`, `/api/errors/{executor}`, and `/api/trade_log` endpoints — none of them mutate, all of them are cookie-authenticated, and the state snapshot is cached for ≤ 10 s so hammering the dashboard does not stall the scanner.

---

## 16. v5 strategy quick reference

> Mirror summary of `STRATEGY.md` for at-a-glance reading. The spec is still authoritative — this section just collects the rule-ID grid in one place so a reader paging through the architecture doc can find the entry/exit thresholds without flipping files.

### 16.1 State machine

```
IDLE —[L-P1/S-P1 gates]→ ARMED —[L-P2-R2 / S-P2-R2 2× DI≥25]→ STAGE_1
   STAGE_1 —[L-P3-R2 / S-P3-R2 2× DI≥30 + winning rule]→ STAGE_2
   STAGE_2 —[next 5m close]→ TRAILING
   TRAILING —[stop / DI<25]→ EXITED —[reclaim once]→ ARMED
   EXITED —[2nd exit]→ LOCKED_FOR_DAY
```

## 16.2 Rule grid

| ID | Where it fires |
|---|---|
| L-P1-G1..G4 | Long permission gates (4 lights on dashboard). |
| L-P2-R1..R5 | Stage-1 long entry (50%, prior-5m-low stop, record entry). |
| L-P3-R1..R5 | Stage-2 long add (full size, safety lock to entry price). |
| L-P4-R1..R4 | TRAILING long: 5m HL ratchet up; stop OR DI<25 ⇒ flatten. |
| L-P5-R1..R3 | Long re-hunt: dormant until reclaim; one shot; 2nd exit ⇒ LOCK. |
| S-P1-G1..G4 | Short permission gates; indices-green vetoes shorts entirely. |
| S-P2-R1..R5 | Stage-1 short entry (50%, prior-5m-high stop). |
| S-P3-R1..R5 | Stage-2 short add; safety lock to entry. |
| S-P4-R1..R5 | TRAILING short: 5m LH ratchet down; **DI<25 priority-1.** |
| S-P5-R1..R3 | Short re-hunt; 2nd exit ⇒ LOCK. |
| C-R1 | Long ⊥ short on same ticker per session. |
| C-R2 | DMI period = 14 (down from v4's 15). |
| C-R3 | Closed-candle entries; tick-rate exits. |
| C-R4 | Daily-loss-limit ⇒ LOCKED_FOR_DAY for all tracks. |
| C-R5 | EOD 15:55 ET force-close. |
| C-R6 | Sovereign Regime Shield global kill. |
| C-R7 | 9-name spike universe; SPY/QQQ pinned, never traded. |

## 16.3 Where the v5 logic lives

| Concern | File / function |
|---|---|
| Rule logic (pure helpers) | `tiger_buffalo_v5.py` (no imports from `trade_genius`) |
| Per-track state | `trade_genius.v5_long_tracks` / `v5_short_tracks` |
| Mutex + active direction | `trade_genius.v5_active_direction` |
| DMI on 1m + 5m timeframes | `trade_genius.v5_di_1m_5m()` |
| First-hour high (L-P1-G4) | `trade_genius.v5_first_hour_high()` |
| Opening-range-low (S-P1-G4) | `trade_genius.v5_opening_range_low_5m()` |
| Lock all tracks | `trade_genius.v5_lock_all_tracks(reason)` |
| Persistence | `paper_state.py` — extends save/load with v5 keys |
| Tests | `smoke_test.py` (search for `L-P` or `S-P`) |

### 16.4 Migration from v4

A v4 paper-state file (no `v5_*` keys) loads cleanly: the loader treats each missing track as IDLE via `tiger_buffalo_v5.load_track()`. The first session under v5.0.0 starts with empty track dicts; the state machine builds up state lazily as gates pass and stages fire. v4 `paper_trades`, `trade_history`, `positions`, `short_positions`, and the daily entry counters all roll forward unchanged.

### 16.5 v5.0.x → v5.1.x — what changed (and what didn't)

The Tiger/Buffalo state machine in §6 is the same code in v5.1.2 as it was in v5.0.0. Every v5.1.x release is observation-only:

| Release | Subject | Behavior change? |
|---|---|---|
| v5.0.2 | Dockerfile `COPY tiger_buffalo_v5.py` + infra-guard test | No (hotfix) |
| v5.0.3 | Per-executor trade-confirmation DM auto-learn (chat-map) | No (plumbing) |
| v5.0.4 | Revert v5.0.3 paper-key fallback (paper/live key strict) | No (safety) |
| v5.1.0 | Forensic Volume Filter ( `volume_profile.py` ) — SHADOW | No (logging) |
| v5.1.1 | Env-driven A/B toggles + 3-config parallel shadow logging | No (logging) |
| v5.1.2 | Forensic capture: bar archive + indicator snapshots | No (logging) |

Result: a v5.0.0 paper-state file still loads cleanly on v5.1.2; the synthetic harness 50/50 byte-equal goldens still match; every entry, exit, sizing, and stop-placement decision is identical to v5.0.0.

---

## 17. Forensic Volume Filter (Anaplan logic) — v5.1.0 → v5.1.2

The §17 layer asks a sharper volume question than the legacy "is volume high" tests: *is this minute's volume higher than the 55-trading-day seasonal average for THIS exact ET timestamp?* Shipped in v5.1.0 in **shadow mode** (computed and logged, but no entry decision changes), extended in v5.1.1 with env-driven A/B toggles and 3-config parallel shadow logging, and again in v5.1.2 with `GEMINI_A` as a 4th shadow config. Through v5.1.2 the gate is **still observation only**: `VOL_GATE_ENFORCE` defaults to `0` and is unchanged.

### 17.1 Volume Library — parameters

| Parameter | Value |
|---|---|
| Window | 55 NYSE trading days, weekends/holidays excluded. |
| Bucket | Per-minute, ET, `"0931".."1559"`. 09:30 auction excluded. |
| Baseline feed | Alpaca historical 1m bars, `feed=sip`, `end < now-16min`. |
| Live feed | Alpaca websocket `/iex` (free-plan, 30-symbol cap). |
| Cross-feed scale | Per-ticker IEX/SIP volume ratio over the window. Median is published on the IEX scale. |
| Per-bucket store | `{"median": int, "p75": int, "p90": int, "n": int}`. |
| Holiday calendar | Hard-coded NYSE list for 2026-2027 in `volume_profile.py`. No new dep. |
| Stale threshold | 36 hours since `build_ts_utc`. |
| Disk format | `/data/volume_profiles/<TICKER>.json` (atomic tmp+rename). |
| Rebuild cadence | Nightly at 21:00 ET (daemon thread); synchronous on startup if any profile is missing or stale. |
| 30-symbol cap | If `len(TICKERS) > 30`, the module hard-disables itself (`VOLUME_PROFILE_ENABLED = False`); the bot trades normally with G4 short-circuited to `DISABLED`. |
| Websocket reconnect | Jittered backoff; 5-min REST replay on resume to repopulate the in-memory volume table. |

### 17.2 V-P1 grid (legacy fixed-threshold evaluator)

`evaluate_g4(ticker, minute_bucket, current_volume, profile, qqq_current_volume, qqq_profile, stage)` returns `{green, reason, ticker_pct, qqq_pct, rule}` with the original v5.1.0 fixed thresholds (Stage 1: ticker ≥ 120% AND QQQ ≥ 100%; Stage 2: ticker ≥ 100%). Preserved unchanged so v5.1.0 grep tooling and the synthetic harness 50/50 byte-equal still pass.

### 17.3 Env-driven active config + helper (v5.1.1+)

`load_active_config()` reads six env vars at module-import time:

| Env var | Default | Role |
|---|---|---|
| `VOL_GATE_ENFORCE` | `0` | Master enforcement flag. Stays `0` through v5.1.2. |
| `VOL_GATE_TICKER_ENABLED` | `1` | Active config: anchor on per-ticker. |
| `VOL_GATE_INDEX_ENABLED` | `1` | Active config: anchor on QQQ. |
| `VOL_GATE_TICKER_PCT` | `70` | Active-config ticker threshold (% of ToD avg). |
| `VOL_GATE_QQQ_PCT` | `100` | Active-config QQQ threshold (% of ToD avg). |
| `VOL_GATE_INDEX_SYMBOL` | `QQQ` | Hard-locked to QQQ. |

Defaults reflect the **Apr 20-24 backtest recommendation**: 70/100 was the best risk-adjusted config (11 trades, +$482.90, 82% win rate; retains 96% of upside vs unfiltered). Garbage-int env values fall back to defaults rather than crash. Env reads are dict-lookup-cheap; the design intent is "set once at deploy, don't flip mid-week."

`evaluate_g4_config(ticker, minute_bucket, current_volume, profile, index_current_volume, index_profile, *, ticker_enabled, index_enabled, ticker_pct, index_pct)` is the per-anchor configurable evaluator used for the parallel shadow lines. It returns `{verdict, reason, ticker_pct, qqq_pct}` with `verdict ∈ {PASS, BLOCK}` and `reason ∈ {OK, LOW_TICKER, LOW_QQQ, STALE_PROFILE, NO_BARS, NO_PROFILE, DISABLED}`.

### 17.4 `SHADOW_CONFIGS` — fixed analysis configs (v5.1.1 → v5.1.2)

`volume_profile.SHADOW_CONFIGS` is a hard-coded **4-tuple** (was 3-tuple in v5.1.1; `GEMINI_A` was added in v5.1.2 after the Apr 20-24 replay flagged it as the only Gemini-suggested config with positive net P&L swing):

| Name | ticker_enabled | index_enabled | ticker_pct | index_pct |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `TICKER+QQQ` | True | True | 70 | 100 |
| `TICKER_ONLY` | True | False | 70 | (unused) |
| `QQQ_ONLY` | False | True | (unused) | 100 |
| `GEMINI_A` | True | True | **110** | **85** |

These are NOT env-driven — env vars only choose which one would gate trades if `VOL_GATE_ENFORCE=1`. The point is that every line of shadow data is comparable across all four configs post-hoc.

### 17.5 Shadow log lines

Per candidate, `_shadow_log_g4` now emits **5** log lines:

```
[V510-SHADOW] ticker=AMD bucket=1448 stage=1 g4=GREEN ticker_pct=84 qqq_pct=112 reason=OK entry_decision=ENT
[V510-SHADOW][CFG=TICKER+QQQ][PCT=70/100] ticker=AMD bucket=1448 stage=1 t_pct=84 qqq_pct=112 verdict=PASS
[V510-SHADOW][CFG=TICKER_ONLY][PCT=70]    ticker=AMD bucket=1448 stage=1 t_pct=84              verdict=PASS
[V510-SHADOW][CFG=QQQ_ONLY][PCT=100]      ticker=AMD bucket=1448 stage=1            qqq_pct=112 verdict=PASS
[V510-SHADOW][CFG=GEMINI_A][PCT=110/85]   ticker=AMD bucket=1448 stage=1 t_pct=84 qqq_pct=112 verdict=BLOCK
```

The first line is the v5.1.0 back-compat line (no `[CFG=...]` prefix); the four `[CFG=...]` lines are the v5.1.1 (3 of them) plus v5.1.2 (adds GEMINI_A = 4 total). `entry_decision` always reflects what the bot actually did — these lines never gate the decision.

### 17.6 Failure modes

| Condition | Reason |
|---|---|
| Profile file missing for ticker | `NO_PROFILE` |
| Profile older than `STALE_HOURS` (36h) | `STALE_PROFILE` |
| Bucket not in profile (e.g. 09:30 or 16:00) | `NO_BUCKET_<T>_<bucket>` |
| `len(TICKERS) > 30` (free IEX cap exceeded) | `DISABLED` |
| Ticker pct < threshold and ticker_enabled | `LOW_TICKER` |
| QQQ pct < threshold and index_enabled | `LOW_QQQ` |

### 17.7 Rollout plan (current)

1. **v5.1.0** — G4 computed and logged. Existing entry decisions unchanged.
2. **v5.1.1** — Env-driven active config + 3 parallel shadow configs per candidate. Defaults preserve v5.1.0 behavior.
3. **v5.1.2** — `GEMINI_A` added as 4th shadow config; forensic capture (§18) closes the asymmetric blind spot where we only logged what fired. Still SHADOW.
4. **Observation window** — Val collects a clean week of 4-config shadow data alongside `[V510-CAND]` skipped-candidate lines and `[V510-MINUTE]` per-minute volume percentiles.
5. **Future PR** — Flip `VOL_GATE_ENFORCE=1` once Val has chosen the best config off live data; G4 joins G1/G2/G3 as a hard ARM precondition (see §19.1).

## 18. Forensic Capture (v5.1.2)

v5.1.2 closes four data gaps so any future backtest is fully replayable from disk:

1. We only logged trades that **fired** — never candidates that didn't.
2. We only logged at the **active threshold** — not the baseline.
3. We did **not persist 1m bars** to disk.
4. We did **not record indicator state** at decision time.

All four streams are observation-only. None of them touch entry, exit, sizing, or stop placement.

### 18.1 Bar archive (`bar_archive.py` — Tier-1.1)

For every minute close per ticker (+ QQQ + SPY) in the active TICKERS list, append one JSONL line to `/data/bars/YYYY-MM-DD/{TICKER}.jsonl`. Schema:

```
{
  "ts": "...", "et_bucket": "1448",
  "open": ..., "high": ..., "low": ..., "close": ...,
  "iex_volume": ..., "iex_sip_ratio_used": ...,
  "bid": ..., "ask": ..., "last_trade_price": ...
}
```

Append in `a` mode; on Linux ext4 a write of < `PIPE_BUF` (4096) is atomic, and the lines are ~150 bytes — no tmp+rename needed. Lazy directory creation. **Failure-tolerant — never raises into the trading loop.** Disk projection: ~18 tickers × 390 minutes × ~150 bytes ≈ 1 MB/day. The 30-symbol IEX cap from v5.1.0 still bounds the universe. Stale or empty minutes write nothing. A daemon thread calls `cleanup_old_dirs(retain_days=90)` nightly to delete dated directories older than 90 days.

### 18.2 Per-minute volume log ( `[V510-MINUTE]` — Tier-1.2)

One line per ticker per minute close, regardless of candidate state:

```
[V510-MINUTE] ticker=AMD bucket=1448 t_pct=84 qqq_pct=112 close=346.19 vol=12345
```

This lets us replay "what if the candidate threshold itself were different" without re-pulling 1m bars from Alpaca.

### 18.3 Skipped-candidate log ( `[V510-CAND]` — Tier-1.3)

Pre-v5.1.2 we only logged candidates that fired. v5.1.2 emits one line on **every entry consideration** — fired AND not-fired:

```
[V510-CAND] ticker=AMD bucket=1448 stage=1 fsm_state=ARMED entered=NO reason=NO_BREAKOUT
            t_pct=84 qqq_pct=112 close=346.19 stop=null
            rsi14=null ema9=null ema21=null atr14=null vwap_dist_pct=null spread_bps=null
```

`reason ∈ {NO_BREAKOUT, STAGE_NOT_READY, ALREADY_OPEN, COOL_DOWN, MAX_POSITIONS, BREAKOUT_CONFIRMED}`. Wired into the entry-consideration loop next to the existing `_shadow_log_g4` call. All `indicators.*` values render as `null` (not `0.0`) on insufficient bars.

### 18.4 Entry log enrichment ( `[V510-ENTRY]` — Tier-1.4)

When a trade fires, a new line is emitted alongside the existing entry surface (Telegram + paper_log) carrying bid/ask + account state:

```
[V510-ENTRY] ticker=AMD bid=346.18 ask=346.20
             cash=85432.10 equity=99214.55
             open_positions=2 total_exposure_pct=18.4 current_drawdown_pct=0.0
```

**Strictly additive** — the existing entry log line, paper_log entry, and Telegram card are unchanged byte-for-byte (the synthetic harness 50/50 byte-equal goldens still pass).

### 18.5 FSM transition log ( `[V510-FSM]` — Tier-2.1)

Pure observation hook. Refuses to emit on `from == to` no-ops (asserted by smoke test). Format:

```
[V510-FSM] ticker=AMD from=IDLE to=WATCHING reason=VOL_SPIKE_DETECTED bucket=1445
```

v5.1.2 ships the emitter only; the wider FSM-call-site sweep is intentionally minimal so we do not accidentally change v5.0.0 Tiger/Buffalo behavior. A future PR will fan the emitter out to every transition site.

### 18.6 Pre-trade indicator snapshots (`indicators.py` — Tier-2.2)

Pure functions, no `trade_genius` imports, no exceptions raised on bad input:

| Function | Inputs | Output | None when |
|---|---|---|---|
| `rsi14(closes)` | closes (newest last) | float | < 15 closes |
| `ema9(closes)` | closes | float | < 9 closes |
| `ema21(closes)` | closes | float | < 21 closes |
| `atr14(bars)` | bars with high/low/close | float | < 15 bars |
| `vwap_dist_pct(bars)` | bars with H/L/C/volume | float | no bars or zero volume |
| `spread_bps(bid, ask)` | bid, ask | float | missing or non-positive |

All values are wired into `[V510-CAND]` so every candidate moment carries the indicator state at decision time. Callers MUST emit `null` (not `0.0`) into log lines on `None` returns.

### 18.7 Out of scope (deferred)

News / halt flags (needs Polygon or Benzinga subscription); L2 / order-book snapshots; tick-level trades; `VOL_GATE_ENFORCE=1`; new env-driven configs beyond v5.1.1; adaptive runtime config switching.

## 19. Long permission gates (G1..G4)

### 19.1 Four-light gate set (v5.1.0+)

| Gate | Light name | Source | Status through v5.1.2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| G1 | Index Alpha | Tiger/Buffalo §6.2 | enforced |
| G2 | Ticker Alpha | Tiger/Buffalo §6.2 | enforced |
| G3 | 5m OR Structure | Tiger/Buffalo §6.2 | enforced |
| G4 | Volume | `volume_profile.evaluate_g4(_config)` | **shadow only — `VOL_GATE_ENFORCE=0` through v5.1.2; flips in a future PR** |

Through v5.1.2 the bot logs G4 every minute via `_shadow_log_g4` but does not block any entry on it. The short-side gates read the same baseline; no short-specific code change.

*Last refresh: April 2026, against `BOT_VERSION = "5.1.2"`.*